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They Want Double in Texas League

Power, Pitching E.P. Hope

(Continued from Page 2)
(Randy) Brown, who hit .226 for San Jose last year.

The Kings will have a right handed first baseman, which seems like an oddity. Husky Rich Ganulin, up from San Jose with a .267 mark and 16 homers, is filling that post.

Another San Jose product, Richard Shibley, who swatted .271 at San Jose, replaces Gordie Avery at second.

TALL JIM VOPICKA is the shortstop and indications are the job will be his permanent-

ly after he had one shot here and after a season in Quad Cities.

The third base spot is earmarked for Gabriel Lugo, who hit .351 for Jalisco in the Mexican League a year ago. He's a little guy who's expected to be the Kings' leadoff batter. Luis Lagunas, an Arizonan,

had been set for this spot until a last-minute deal gave El Paso Lugo.

The cohesion of the infield has yet to be settled due to the fact that Lugo has not worked out with the team. The fielding proficiencies of the Kings' inner works is yet to be fully tested.

THE KINGS had the best outfield in the Texas League last year and this year's crew may not be far off that mark. They have Carlos (Bobby) Trevino, who was hitting over .300 here last year when the big club, the California Angels, called him. He's back and is the top candidate for hitting honors in the Texas League.

Then there's husky Bill Parlier, who's fighting his way up after a spectacular start in the Texas League with Albuquerque in 1964 and a decline in batting. He hit 24 homers for San Jose last year. With that kind of power, he should like Dudley Field.

The rookie of the outfield is Mike Floyd who hit .260 for San Jose last season.

A FORMER El Paso favorite, Ethan (Blackie) Blackburn, a left handed swinging outfielder, is returning to El Paso. He's a well-tested veteran who can be counted on to hit close to the .300 mark in the Texas League. His acquirement more than offsets the loss of Jim DeNeff, who quit the team because of a salary dispute.

Larry (Moose) Stubing returns to the club as pinch-hitter, utility man and player-coach. And his big bat, which he has swung with devastating effect in past Texas League seasons, will be in use this season more than ever due to the new "wild card" rule. A pinch-hitter can bat one or more times, according to the new rule.

The club, with Rice hand-picking the players and Roland Hemond, the Angels farm director, giving his approval, looks solid from a pitching and power hitting standpoint. How good it's going to be will not be determined until all the other clubs have been confronted.

Llenas, Avery, Wayne Bethea 2-Base Champs

For the last four seasons, El Paso batters have either led the Texas League in doubles or tied for the lead.

Winston Llenas, playing third base for the Kings, was the champion in 1965 with 39. He and Leo Posada of Amarillo tied for the lead with 28 in 1966. Gordon Avery, El Paso's second baseman, was the top man in 1967 with 38 and last year, Wayne Bethea, playing a utility role, for El Paso, led with 31.

HUNT'S WIN RECORD
Lynn Hunt, who is hurling for the U.T. El Paso Miner baseball team this year collected the most wins for a pitcher in one season in 1967 and 1968 with eight and seven respectively.

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CORONADO SLUGGER
DAVID MALONE

District Baseball Is Strong

By BERT SALAZAR
Coach K. C. Brown of Austin, whose 1965 team advanced from the regional playoffs into the state tourney, is optimistic about this season's local prep baseball teams.

Brown says that El Paso schools are talented and that it will take some good pitchers to pull them through.

AND BETTER then average pitchers are plentiful in El Paso but they are scattered.

Coach Brown had a good one in Bob Brown then when he lost to a Dallas team in eight innings in the state playoffs. Austin finished third in the state that year.

COACH NEMO Herrera of Coronado believes this year's teams are well balanced and that it will also be up to the pitchers for most of the wins.

There are three southpaws in El Paso who have already proven themselves.

THEY ARE Dickie Jones of Coronado, Jim Greggerson of Ysleta and Ruben Molina of Jefferson.

Other hurlers who are faring well are Pat Carden and Sam Camilli of Austin, Adolph Varela of Irvin, Albert Dominguez of Bel Air, Manny Delgado and Tony Becerra of Tech, Phil Darwin of Coronado, Mike Beltran of Ysleta and Frank Del Toro of Jefferson.

EASTWOOD has some of the top hitters in El Paso but will have to develop a top pitcher to win the championship.

It looks like the El Paso High Tigers of coach Ken Moorehead have not found their No. 2 pitcher yet. The on again off again Bengals will have to rely mostly on David Villareal's pitching which will not be enough to win the title.

AUSTIN, Irvin and Coronado should battle it out for the title in 1-AAAA. Bel Air, Jefferson and Ysleta should be the ones fighting it out in 2-AAAA.

A lot will depend on how many games Bowie and Andrews can win in their respective districts. Both of them are capable of surprising the stronger teams.

New All-Star Format Set

A new format for the Texas League All-Star game will be used for the 1969 season.

Instead of pitting the Texas League Stars against the Houston Astros in the Dallas-Fort Worth's Spur Stadium as has been customary for several seasons, this year's game will have the West Stars meeting the East Stars at Blues Stadium in Memphis on July 29.

The West teams in the league are El Paso, Albuquerque, Amarillo and Dallas-Fort Worth. East teams are Shreveport, Memphis, Arkansas and San Antonio.

Sun Kings Openings

Here's how the Sun Kings have fared in all their Texas League openings:

1962—El Paso 4, Albuquerque 2
1963—El Paso 7, Albuquerque 5 (in El Paso)
1964—El Paso 4, Albuquerque 1 (in Albuquerque)
1965—Albuquerque 7, El Paso 4 (in El Paso)
1966—Albuquerque 3, El Paso 1 (in Albuquerque)
1967—Albuquerque 4, El Paso 2 (in Albuquerque)
1968—Albuquerque 4, El Paso 2 (in Albuquerque)

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MINER SLUGGERS—John Miller, (left) and Rick Butler have been providing the wood for Andy Cohen's U.T. El Paso Miner baseball team this season. Miller leads the team in batting and Butler has the RBI lead. (Herald-Post photo by Bill Thompson)

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